

store her marriage. She became a partner with her husband and recommitted her vows to honor him. She took a job at a much lower salary and merged her assets totally with Marty's. There was very little left over for a clothes binge or eating out with the girls, but Karen and Marty became *one*.

Beware if you begin to feel like saying, "Listen, I work all week long. I need some money for myself. It's not fair that I have to spend all *my* money paying bills." Remember that it isn't fair, and God never said that it would be. A marriage is not a 50/50 relationship, as many people think. It's a 95/5 relationship on both sides. You must be willing to yield 95 percent of your rights to your spouse, both of you. If you're not willing to do that, it won't work.

I have seen a great many marriages where husbands and wives maintained separate checking accounts, took separate vacations, and said they got along fine. I believe that's a rationalization for living a lie. God's Word says that He created a husband and wife to become one. "For this cause a man shall leave his father and his mother, and shall cleave to his wife; and they shall become one flesh" (Genesis 2:24).

Nobody will ever convince a knowledgeable counselor that "separate but equal" will ever work in a marriage. All it means is that the couple has learned to compromise God's best and live with it. If you find that's true in your marriage, you need to seek counsel immediately. Get a third party who's objective and trained to help. No viable marriage can survive a his/her relationship for long. They may live in the same house. They may even sleep in the same bed, but they've learned to live separate lives. That is totally contrary to God's plan.

DANGER SIGN: LACK OF COMMUNICATIONS

As I said before, a danger sign in any marriage is *poor communications*. I've heard a wife say many times, "It's amazing how much we talked before we got married and how little we talk now." Do you know why? It's because you had an incentive: to win him or her. Now your motivation should be to please God. Take the time to communicate and you'll develop a strong